Stephen Barr

Founder of FocusOn CRM | Software Architect and Engineer

Northern Ireland, UK | linkedin.com/in/stephenbbarr
A more detailed CV is available on request through LinkedIn.

Profile

Founder of FocusOn CRM and a hands-on software architect and engineer with more than ten years of experience. Building software for organisations delivering employment, skills and careers programmes, with responsibility for business direction, product development and software architecture. Brings experience leading engineering teams, delivering large public-service platforms and running reliable production services. Focused on building and supporting FocusOn CRM for the long term.

Professional Experience

FocusOn CRM

Founder, Software Architect and Engineer

- **Business and product direction:** Lead the business, set product priorities and guide development around customer needs.
- **Architecture and development:** Design and build a configurable .NET platform for organisations delivering employment, skills and careers programmes.
- **Programme flexibility:** Build separate programme workspaces within one shared system, supporting different activities, outcomes and delivery needs.
- **Reliable foundations:** Build access controls, versioned evidence management and resilient background processing, supported by automated testing and AI-assisted development with human review.

Education Development Trust

Systems Architect / Lead Software Engineer

- **Built and scaled a public-service platform:** Designed a configurable, multi-tenant platform that replaced repeated bespoke development and expanded across more than a dozen programmes supporting hundreds of thousands of people.
- **Led and developed engineers:** Remained hands-on in C#/.NET while leading engineers and analysts. Recruited engineers, designed technical assessments and supported progression through feedback and coaching. Met every agreed programme deadline by balancing scope and priorities.
- **Owned production reliability:** Resolved application, data, cloud and integration issues and added controls to prevent recurrence. Delivered software within ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- **Reduced annual cloud costs by more than 90%:** Replaced continuously running workloads with event-driven services and improved storage, database and caching efficiency.
- **Introduced controlled AI-assisted delivery:** Established workflows for planning, implementation, testing and review, retaining human approval for technical decisions and production releases.

E+I Engineering Ltd.

Software Systems Developer

Software Development Internship

- **Independent delivery:** Designed and delivered full-stack .NET applications.
- **Operational systems:** Built systems supporting inventory, logistics, manufacturing and maintenance workflows.
- **Full-stack breadth:** Worked across application development, databases, user interfaces, cloud services and delivery pipelines.

Foods Connected Ltd.

Software Systems Developer

- **Full-stack delivery:** Delivered features for a large supply-chain platform.
- **Product development:** Implemented business logic, web interfaces, product changes and production fixes.

Selected Projects

AI Careers-support Prototype

- **Applied AI:** Built an AI-assisted prototype for transcription, summarisation and contextual careers information using anonymised inputs.

Core Technology

C#, .NET, ASP.NET Core, Blazor, SQL Server, Azure, Git, CI/CD, xUnit and OpenAI Codex.

Education

- **Ulster University:** BEng (Hons) Computer Games Development with Diploma in Professional Practice.
- **North West Regional College:** Higher National Diploma in Computing and Systems Development.